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A Hebrew-Greek Amulet for Nonna, Daughter of Marcellina

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ABSTRACT: The present article consists of the edition of a Hebrew-Greek amulet inscribed on a thin sheet of silver for a certain Nonna, daughter of Marcellina. It contains a florilegium of chiefly biblical verses and uses some technical, medical terminology, some of which is gynecological.

Keywords: amulets, Hebrew, Greek, Hebrew Bible, medicine, women

THE AMULET

The present article consists of the edition of a bilingual (Hebrew-Greek) protective amulet that is of interest for its citation of many biblical verses and Jewish liturgical formulae and the use of some specialized Greek medical terminology.¹ The text is inscribed on a thin sheet of silver, 13.1 cm high and 4.1 cm wide (figs. 1–2). It was acquired after 2000 by the late Shlomo Moussaieff and was recently sold to Lenny Wolfe, to whom we are grateful for permission to publish it. It was first studied by Dan Levene and the late David Jordan, who passed their readings on to us for further analysis and publication.

The text of the amulet has two parts. The first (lines 1–28) is written in Hebrew, and the second (lines 29–[49]) is in Greek. In ancient bilingual texts, it often is difficult to tell whether the same hand wrote both parts. However, in the case of the present amulet, it is clear that two hands were at work, especially because

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Fig. 1. Line-drawing of the amulet (produced by Rivka Elitzur-Leiman and Robert Daniel)



Fig. 2. Photograph of the amulet (by Matthew Morgenstern)

the Hebrew text was inscribed with greater pressure, resulting in deeper and clearer letters, whereas the Greek letters are shallower, making the text harder to decipher. Furthermore, although word division frequently occurs in the Greek text (lines 29–30, 32–33, 33–34, etc.), it is avoided in the Hebrew. Hence, blank spaces occur at the end of many lines (3, 10, 13, etc.), and words are squeezed into a relatively small space at the end of others (8, 9, 20, etc.). Chiefly on the basis of the palaeography of the Greek hand, we tentatively date the amulet to the fourth or fifth centuries CE.²

The Hebrew part of the amulet consists almost entirely of biblical verses that glorify the God of Israel and request his assistance. In the Greek section, a long list of epithets that are commonly applied to the God of Israel is followed by singular imperatives which command him to heal and grant deliverance to Nonna, daughter of Marcellina. The Hebrew, as well as the Greek parts, are phrased in the first person. This is unusual in ancient Jewish amulets and protective amulets in general, where the wearer is usually mentioned in the third person.³

Our amulet displays many similarities with another bilingual Hebrew-Greek amulet, GMA 56 (=CIIP V 6107), found near Kibbutz Evron in the Western Galilee, not far from Nahariya, and assigned to the third to fourth centuries CE.⁴ The Hebrew part of the Evron amulet likewise contains mainly divine names and praises of God, while its Greek text, like the new amulet, contains the client's name and a more specific set of requests. The several close verbal correspondences between the two texts are noted below in the commentary. Furthermore, the new amulet suggests an improved reconstruction of a problematic passage in the Evron amulet (see below, commentary on lines 34–35). We tentatively posit that the makers of the two amulets used similar formularies and/or that both amulets were produced by the same magical atelier.

2 For the dates of Jewish amulets found in controlled excavations, see Elitzur-Leiman and Leibner 2016: 229.

3 For a broad overview of the Jewish amulets of late antiquity, see Elitzur-Leiman 2021.

4 This date was assigned to the text by Kotansky in GMA 56 and accepted by O. Abudraham and R. Daniel in their republication of the text in CIIP V 6107. In the first edition (Kotansky 1991), however, the text was assigned to a slightly later date, to the fourth to fifth centuries CE.

Translation	Hebrew and Greek texts
1 JTH TH HH HY YH WH HW	1 [תה תה הה הי יה וה הו
2 HW YHW Y'W ŠB' Sabaoth YHWH	2 הו יהו יאו צבא צבאות יהוה
3 'DN 'DN'Y our Master 'DNYH	3 אדן אדנאי אדנינו אדניה
4 God, my God, ELOHIM, our God, YH	4 אלה אלהי אלהים אלהינו יה
5 El Shadday, mighty YH, holy HW	5 אל שדי חסין יה קדוש הן
6 WHY WHW YHW HYH YHWH YHWH	6 והי והו יהו היה יהוה יהוה
7 A hand upon the throne of the Lord He is the God YH	7 כי יד על כס יה הוא האל יה
8 the great, mighty, and awesome, God Most High,	8 הגדל הגיבר והנורא אל עליון
9 creator of heaven and earth, I am who	9 קונה שמים וארץ אהיה אשר
10 I am, YHWH is God; He has given us light.	10 אהיה אל יהוה ויאר לנו
11 Blessed is the name of the glory of his kingdom for ever	11 ברוך שם כבוד מלכותו לעלם
12 and ever, YHWH, YHWH, a merciful and gracious God,	12 ועד יהוה יהוה אל רחום וחנון
13 longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth.	13 ארך אפים ורב חסד ואמת
14 YHWH the God Sabaoth, who is mighty like	14 יהוה אלהי צבאות מי כמוכה
15 you, YH, and your faithfulness surrounds me.	15 חסין יה ואמונתך סביבותי
16 YHWH lives, and blessed be my rock, and let the God	16 חי יהוה וברוך צורי וירם אלהי
17 of my deliverance be exalted. YHWH Sabaoth is with us,	17 ישעי יהוה צבאות עימנו
18 the God of Jacob is our haven, Selah.	18 מסגב לנו אלהי יעקוב סלה
19 YH is my strength and might; He becomes my deliverance.	19 עזי וזמרת יה ויהי לי לישועה
20 This is my God and I will enshrine him; The God of my father, and I will exalt him,	20 זה אלי ואנוהו אלהי אבי וארוממנו
21 YHWH, a man of war, YHWH is his name.	21 יהוה איש מלחמה יהוה שמו
22 Who is like You, YHWH, among the gods, who is like you	22 מי כמוכה באלים יהוה מי כמוכה
23 majestic in holiness, awesome in splendor,	23 נאדר בקודש נורא תהילות
24 working wonders. YYY HHH WWW HHH	24 עשה פלא יי ההה ווו ההה
25 God, and God, the God; You are God, Your name is God,	25 אל ואל האל אתה אל שמך אל
26 Rabel, Kolel, the God, holy	26 רבאל כלאל האלהים קודש
27 (is) your name. Give me healing, healing ⁵ a good life,	27 שמך תן לי אסו רפואה חיים טובים
28 all healing, deliverance in peace, Amen Selah.	28 כל רפוא ישועה בשלום אמן סלה
29 Holy (is) the Lord, holy, holy, Highest,	29 Ἅγιος κύριος, ἅγιος, ἅγιος, ὑψισ-
30 strong, sufficient, eternal,	30 τος, ἡσυχυρός, ἱκανός, ἐώνιος,
31 making wonders, save,	31 ποιῶν θαυμαστά, σῶσον,
32 heal, treat and bestow	32 ἴασε, θεράπευσον καὶ δώ-
33 full health and deliverance	33 ρησαι πᾶσαν ὑγίαν καὶ σω-
34 to the entire body	34 τηρίαν παντὶ τοῦ σώμα-
35 from hidden and manifest (ailments) –	35 τι κρυπτῶν καὶ φανερῶ<v>
36 (the body) of me, Nonna, to whom Marcellina	36 ἐμοῦ, Νόννας, τῆς ἔτεκεν

30 ἡσυχυρός αἰώνιος 32 ἴασαι 33 ὑγείαν 34 τῷ 36 τῆς = ἧς

5 The word is written first in Aramaic, and once again in Hebrew.

Translation	Hebrew and Greek texts
37 gave birth, so that I also be saved from	37 Μαρκελλῖνα, <ἵνα> καὶ ἀπὸ θεο-
38 divine wrath, be saved from	38 χολωσίας σωθῶ, ἀπὸ ὀφ-
39 every (evil) eye, be saved	39 θαλμοῦ παντὸς σωθῶ,
40 from the daemon, be saved	40 ἀπὸ δεμονίου σωθῶ,
41 from the hour, be saved from	41 ἀπὸ ὥρας σωθῶ, ἀπὸ π-
42 a spirit (or, from air), be saved from	42 γεύματος σωθῶ, ἀπὸ ἐμ-
43 inflation, be saved	43 πνευματώσεως σωθῶ,
44 from drowsiness of the head,	44 ἀπὸ καρώσεως κρανίου
45 be saved from polyemia, be saved	45 σφθῶ, ἀπὸ πολυεμίας σω-
46 from cacochymia, be saved	46 θῶ, ἀπὸ κακοχυμίας σω-
47 from excess of humor,	47 θῶ, ἀπὸ πλήθους χυμορ[ῶ]
48 be saved from (ailment of) the womb,	48 σφθῶ, ἀπὸ ὑστήρας
49 [be saved] ...	49 [σωθῶ] . [...] - - - - -

40 δαιμονίου 45 πολυαιμία 48 ὑστέρας

COMMENTARY

1–2 [תָּהָה הָהִי יֵה וְהָהוּ יְהוּ יֵאוּ צָבָא צְבָאוֹת יְהוָה]: similar to the opening of the Evron amulet, הַנְּהַהֵהִי יֵה יְהוּ צְבָאוֹת יְהוָה.⁶

4 אֱלֹהִים אֱלֹהֵינוּ: attested in Ps 67:7 and perhaps intended as a biblical citation.

5 אֵל שְׂדֵי חֲסִין יֵה: based on biblical building blocks. For אֵל שְׂדֵי, cf. e.g., Gen 17:1. The words חֲסִין יֵה are found in Ps 89:9 (cf. lines 14–15), and the formula אֵל שְׂדֵי חֲסִין יֵה is found in later Jewish magical texts, e.g., MS Sassoon 290 (now Geneva 145, early sixteenth century), p. 238, lines 11–12.⁷

5–6 The permutations of יְהוּ recall the claim in the *Sefer Yešira* 15 that God sealed the six edges of the universe with the six permutations of the letters YHW (Haymann 2004: 89–91). However, such sequences are common in Jewish magical texts and are paralleled by permutations of the seven vowels and subsets thereof commonly found in Greek magical texts (Bohak 2008: 265).

7–24 These lines contain mostly biblical verses, cited in full or in part. Such a large conglomeration of biblical verses is striking, but florilegia of the same nature are well attested in other Jewish amulets⁸ and liturgical texts (Elizur 2006; Naeh 2006; Langer 2007). The citations in the current florilegium are mostly

6 We have slightly modified Kotansky’s reading, in keeping with his line-drawing.

7 For an image of this page, see <http://www.e-codices.unifr.ch/en/bge/cl0145/238>.

8 For example, AMB, Amulet 4; Kotansky, Naveh and Shaked 1992; Angel 2009; Shaked, Ford and Bhayro 2013: 18–20.

intended to highlight God's great powers but also feature his special relations with the Jewish people (the God of Jacob... this is my God) and his granting of deliverance.

7 וַיֹּאמֶר כִּי יָד עַל כָּס יְהוָה מְלַחֶמָה לִיהוָה בְּעֶמְלֵק מִדֶּד דָּר cf. Ex 17:16: כִּי יָד עַל כָּס יְהוָה.

7–9 קונה שמים וארץ ... האל הגדל: this combination of (parts of) Deut 10:17 (or Neh 9:32) and Gen 14:19 (or 14:22) is found in the first blessing (*Avot*) of the Eighteen Benedictions, or the Jewish daily prayer, and is typical of the Palestinian (rather than the Babylonian) branch of the textual transmission of this blessing (Ehrlich 2013: 31–42).⁹ It is also found in the so-called 'Substance of the seven' (ברכה אחת מעין שבע) recited in the synagogue on Friday night (Tal 1972).

8 הגיבור: This is either a defective spelling of הגיבור or a reflection of an Aramaic pronunciation: gibbār.

9–10 אהיה אשר אהיה: a frequent formula in ancient Jewish amulets (cf. e.g., AMB, Amulets 2, 3, 11, and 12). In the Evron amulet, it is embedded in a long series of God's names, יהוה צבאות יהוה אלוהים [אה]יה אשר אהיה האל יהוה האל האלוהים. Its origins are in Ex 3:14, cited in its entirety in one late-antique Jewish amulet (Yardeni and Bohak 2016).

10 אל יהוה ויאָר לנו אָסְרו חַג בְּעֶבְתִּים עַד קִרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ: cf. Ps 118:27: אֵל יְהוָה וַיֹּאֲרֵנוּ וַיֹּאֲרֵנוּ.

11 ברוך שם ... ועד: this liturgical formula is not found in the Hebrew Bible (but cf. Dan 2:20: ... לְהוֹדָא שְׁמָהּ דִּי אֱלֹהָא מְבָרַךְ מִן עַלְמָא וְעַד עַלְמָא ...) and is first attested in the Mishna (m Yoma 3.8, 4.1–2, 6.2, etc.). It serves as a public response to a prayer recited by an individual and is akin to the recitation of *Amen*.¹⁰ It similarly functions as a response to the first verse in the recitation of the Shema^c ('Hear O Israel') and is attested in this context in several incantation bowls from Late-Antiquity Babylonia (Levene 2003: 106, 107, 112; 2005; Morgenstern 2021). It also occurs in an amulet for a Kometisa, daughter of Martha (being edited by R. Elitzur-Leiman). It is frequent in medieval Jewish magical texts.¹¹ In most cases, the liturgical formula 'Blessed be the Name...' comes as a response to the ineffable name of God or other holy names, as documented already in Mishna Yoma 4.1: '(And upon saying the name of God), the priests and the people respond after him: Blessed be the name of his glorious kingdom forever and all time.' Perhaps, then, the writer of the present amulet perceived the Hebrew lines 1–11, or at least

9 As noted by Ehrlich, the formula קונה שמים וארץ is rare in the Babylonian texts, where the standard formula is קונה הכל.

10 For its early history, see Aptowitz 1929; Kimelman 2005; Kister 2010: 272–273, n. 41.

11 See, e.g., MTKG I, 2 (=Cambridge, Taylor-Schechter K 1.56), 1b/2–3; I, 5 (=New York, Jewish Theological Seminary Library ENA2643.6–7), 7a/25; I, 20 (=Cambridge, Taylor-Schechter K 1.147), 1a/41.

parts thereof, as a sequence of holy names of God and the following lines 12–24 as a florilegium of biblical verses, which did not call for this liturgical formula.

12–13 וַיַּעֲבֹר יְהוָה עַל פְּנֵיו וַיִּקְרָא יְהוָה אֶל רַחוּם: cf. Ex 34:6: וַיַּעֲבֹר יְהוָה עַל פְּנֵיו וַיִּקְרָא יְהוָה אֶל רַחוּם, and Ps 86:15: וַיַּעֲבֹר יְהוָה עַל פְּנֵיו וַיִּקְרָא יְהוָה אֶל רַחוּם. Rabbinic literature sees Ex 34:6–7 as a list of the ‘thirteen attributes’ (*middot*) of God. These two verses are frequently used in liturgical and especially penitential contexts. The present amulet, however, cites only the first of the two verses (or Ps 86:15, which is based upon it) and is the only ancient Jewish magical text, to our knowledge, that cites this verse so fully, although a few amulets contain fragments thereof.¹² Its use in oaths and adjurations is further reflected in the Mishna (m Shevuot 4.13) and several Babylonian incantation bowls (Levene 2007: 61, 65). In medieval Jewish magical texts, one sometimes finds Ex 34:6–7 cited together, and sometimes, as here, only 34:6.¹³

14–15 יהוה אלהי צבאות מי כמוך חסין יה ואמונתך: cf. Ps 89:9: יהוה אלהי צבאות מי כמוך חסין יה ואמונתך. This verse is unattested in other ancient Jewish magical texts. If סביבותי instead of סביבותיך is correctly read, the meaning is no longer ‘and your faithfulness surrounds you’ but ‘and your faithfulness surrounds me.’ If this is not a scribal error, it is an interesting example of the modification of a biblical verse designed to enhance its magical power (cf. further examples in Bohak 2008: 309–312). Alternatively, one can read: סביבותו, ‘surrounds him.’ In this case, the scribe may have been influenced by the previous verse in the same psalm, 89:8, which ends with סביביו, a slightly different form of the same word.

16–17 חי יהוה וברוך צורי ויִרְם אלהי צור ישעי: cf. 2 Sam 22:47: חי יהוה וברוך צורי ויִרְם אלהי צור ישעי, and Ps 18:47: חי יהוה וברוך צורי ויִרְם אלהי צור ישעי.

17–18 יהוה צבאות עמנו משגב לנו אלהי יעקב: cf. Ps 46:8, 12: יהוה צבאות עמנו משגב לנו אלהי יעקב. This verse is cited in two other ancient Jewish amulets, and in at least two incantation bowls from Babylonia.¹⁴

19–21 עזי וזמרת יה ויהי לי לישועה זה: cf. Ex 15:2–3: עזי וזמרת יה ויהי לי לישועה זה. יהוה איש מלחמה יהוה שמו (for the first verse, cf. also Ps 118:14: עזי וזמרת יה ויהי לי לישועה). These verses, from the Song of the Sea (Ex 15:1–19), are found in several contexts in the Jewish liturgy, including

12 In MSF, Amulet 28, in line 8 one should read ארך אפים (as newly read by R. Elitzur-Leiman). MSF, Amulet 24, אל חנון ומלך רחום is probably based on the same biblical verse.

13 For both verses, see MSF, Geniza 13 (=Cambridge, Taylor-Schechter K 1.57), 1/12–14; for the first only, see MSF, Geniza 29 (=Cambridge, Cambridge University Library, Or. 1080.6.19), 1/3–4 (citing only part of the first verse).

14 See MSF, Amulets 17 and 29; Levene 2013: 122; CAMIB 41:20–21.

the morning prayers, where the entire Song is recited at the end of the Verses of Hymn (*Psukei-dezimra*) section.

22–24 מִי כִמְכָה בְּאֵלִם יְהוָה מִי כִמְכָה נֶאֱדָר בְּקֶדֶשׁ: cf. Ex 15:11: מִי כִמְכָה ... עֲשֵׂה פֶלֶא נִוְרָה תְהִלַּת עֲשֵׂה פֶלֶא. This verse is taken from the same biblical text as the previous two verses and, like them, stresses God's great powers. It is worth mentioning that in a Jewish Babylonian incantation bowl it is attested directly next to its Aramaic translation (Targum Onkelos).¹⁵ For עֲשֵׂה פֶלֶא, cf. also below on ποιῶν θαυμαστά in line 31.

[illegible]

24–26 closely paralleled the Evron amulet's [] אל בבל אל שמך אתה אל ואל האל אתה אל שמך אל ורבאל כלאל. יהוה אל ואל האל אתה אל שמך אל בבל [] אל. The formula אתה אל ואל האל אתה אל שמך אל בבל [] אל, 'you are God, your Name is God,' is, to our knowledge, not found in other Jewish texts.

26 וּרְבָאֵל כְּלָאֵל: possibly angels' names, but they would be out of place in this sentence. Perhaps one should emend to וּרְבָאֵל כְּלָאֵל, 'and mighty over every god' but this is elsewhere unattested.

27–28 אִסּוּ רְפוּאָה... רְפוּאָה: The word אִסּוּ is the only Aramaic word in the first section of the text, which, otherwise, is written in pure Hebrew. The Aramaic-Hebrew duplicate אִסּוּ רְפוּאָה can be compared to an amulet from the Golan Heights: שְׁלַח רְפוּי אִסּוּ לְאַלְעֶזֶר, where Naveh and Shaked suggested that אִסּוּ ‘may serve as a gloss on the Hebrew word *rpwy*.’¹⁶ In light of the word רְפוּי in the Golan Heights amulet, it seems that רְפוּאָה in our line 28 may be a non-standard spelling of רְפוּי.

29 Ἄγιος κύριος: the Greek section of the Evron amulet likewise opens with this expression, but it next refers to God's creation of the universe by his word.

30 Ἄγιος ... ἄγιος, ἄγιος: the trisagion, based on Isa 6:3, is a common Jewish liturgical formula, probably going back to the Second Temple period and is also common in Christian liturgies (Fleischer 1998; Weinfeld 2004: 22–26). It is frequent in ancient Jewish and Christian amulets.¹⁷

30 *ἱκανός*: an ancient ‘translation’ of the Hebrew name of God, Shadday (שׁדַּי, as above in l. 5); cf. e.g., Epiphanius, *Adv. Haer.* 40.5.10–11 (II p. 86 Holl), and see DDD: 749–753 s.v. Shadday; Kosior 2016.

15 ZHSJ 12: 5–6 (=AIBMC 92: 5–6)

16 AMB: 55, Amulet 3, lines 18–20.

17 See, e.g., AMB, Amulet 12; SM 25.5–6; de Bruyn 2017: 191–195.

31 ποιῶν θαυμαστά: this may translate Ex 15:11 פִּלְאָה וְשִׁעָה, which appears in l. 24. The LXX usually has ποιῶν τέρατα, but cf. LXX Judg 13:19 rec. Α τῷ θαυμαστὰ ποιοῦντι κυρίῳ.

31–33 σῶσον, ἴασε, θεράπευσον καὶ δώρησαι: imperatives addressed to God are common in Greek magical texts, where the God of Israel is often one of many gods. However, in Aramaic and Hebrew magical texts, although one often finds commands addressed to angels or demons, God is usually addressed more respectfully and prayerfully.

32–37 δώρησαι πᾶσαν ὑγίαν καὶ σωτηρίαν παντὶ τοῦ σώματι ... ἐμοῦ, Νόννας, τῆς ἔτεκεν Μαρκελλίνα: close to the Evron amulet's ll. 8–9 δωρήσε ὑγίαν, σωτήριαν παντός τοῦ σώματος Κασίου, οὗ ἔτεκεν Μητραδώτιον.

35–36 κρυπτῶν καὶ φανερῶ<ν> | ἐμοῦ: reminiscent of Deut 29:28, which LXX Deut 29:29 translates as τὰ κρυπτὰ Κυρίῳ τῷ θεῷ ὑμῶν, τὰ δὲ φανερά ὑμῖν καὶ τοῖς τέκνοις ὑμῶν. However, in the present amulet, the phrase seems to refer to 'hidden and manifest' evils, mainly medical in nature, although a supernatural cause of some ailments (e.g., epilepsy) is likely and is never entirely excluded. The language is strikingly similar to *Acta Philippi* 41.5 Ἰησοῦς ἐστὶν ὁ ἐμός ἰατρός, ὁ τῶν κρυπτῶν καὶ φανερῶν ἰατρός.¹⁸ We suggest that the Evron amulet contains a similar phrase in a corrupt form in ll. 12–13, transcribed in GMA 56 as follows: κ[αὶ] | τῶν ἀποκρύφων αὐτοῦ καὶ καλῶν αὐτοῦ. While the words καὶ τῶν ἀποκρύφων αὐτοῦ are plausibly the equivalent of καὶ τῶν κρυπτῶν αὐτοῦ, the following καὶ καλῶν αὐτοῦ, which makes no sense in the context, should be emended to καὶ <ἀπο>καλ<υπτ>ῶν αὐτοῦ – in agreement with the substance of φανερῶ<ν> ἐμοῦ of our new amulet. For the words ἀπόκρυφος and ἀποκαλυπτός contrasted with each other, cf. e.g., LXX Sir 42:19 ἀποκαλύπτων ἵχνη ἀποκρύφων.

36 Νόννα: probably originally a so-called *Lallname* (e.g., 'mama,' 'papa') of Levantine origin that was popular among Jews and, later, Christians (Bonner 1954; CIIP III 2175 comm.)

37 Μαρκελλίνα: the Greek equivalents of the Latin names *Marcellinus*/*Marcellina* were common throughout the Greek-speaking world; cf. e.g., the online search function of the LGPN, s.vv. (<https://www.lgpn.ox.ac.uk/search>). Μαρκελλίνα, <ῖνα>: haplography.

37–49 <ῖνα> καὶ ἀπὸ θεο|χολωσίας σωθῶ + at least another ten constructions phrased ἀπὸ *ailment* x σωθῶ: for ῖνα σωθῶ, cf. e.g., NT Mark 5:23; Acts 16:30.

18 *Acta Philippi* 41.5 is connected with the concept of Jesus as Heavenly Physician, i.e., ἰατρός οὐράνιος or *medicus caelestis*; cf. SM 36.13–14 with comments.

37–38 θεο|χολωσίας: LSJ s.v. θεοχολωσία refers to Iohannes Lydus and Byzantine scholia. For θεοῦ χόλος, a mainly Jewish (and later also Christian) concept, cf. *Sib. Or.* 1.400, 3.556; Josephus, *AJ* 9.249; *BJ* 7.34; Origen, *Cels.* 4.22.

38–39 ἀπὸ ὀφθαλμοῦ παντός: cf. GMA 52.103 ἀπὸ ὀφθαλμοῦ, likewise with ellipsis of a word such as πονηροῦ (LXX Sir 31:13; NT Matth. 6:23), κακοῦ (AA, p. 115.4) or βασκάνου (Heliodorus, *Aeth.* 3.7).

40–41 ἀπὸ δαιμονίου σωθῶ, | ἀπὸ ὥρας σωθῶ: for superstitious persons blaming an altercation or a disease resulting from physical injury on an evil demon and an evil hour, cf. John Chrysostom, *Hom. in Joh.* 4.5 (59.51 Migne) οἱ δὲ ἀλογώτεροι καὶ δαίμονας πονηροὺς καὶ ὥραν αἰτοῦνται κακὴν τῶν γεγεννημένων. For gods that preside over hours, days, and weeks, cf. e.g., PGM XIII 53–55, 378–379. For Byzantine horoscopes that list the angels and evil daemons operative at each hour of the seven days of the week, cf. e.g., AA, pp. 434–441, and see Boudet 2003. Similar formulations also appear in Jewish liturgical and magical texts. For example, in the morning blessings, there is a long request for protection ‘from the evil hours, from the harmful rumors, from an evil demon, from an evil eye, ... from the hours that are harmful, brazen, renewed, forthcoming and setting out,’ followed by a citation of Ps 46:8, 12, which is also cited in the Hebrew text (lines 17–18).¹⁹

41–42 πνεύματος: the word *pneuma* might be used for an evil spirit (BDAG s.v. πνεῦμα 4.c) and/or as a medical term for a substance related to air and which, in an imbalanced state, can be a cause of disease.²⁰ The aforementioned δαιμόνιον points in one direction, the following ἐμπνευμάτωσις in the other.

42–43 ἐμπνευματώσεως: Diocles of Carystus, fr. 127 (van der Eijk) seems to be the earliest known attestation of this medical term, which denotes an excess of *pneuma* and is often translated as ‘inflation.’ *Empneumatosis* seems to have affected chiefly the gastrointestinal tract²¹ and the womb (Repici 2020: 43–44).²² Since the present amulet was made for a female, either type of ‘inflation’ might have been intended.

19 See Marx 2008: 12–13, 21–22; cf. Raziel-Kretzmer 2018: 99–101, 124, 352, 357, 368.

20 See Coughlin, Leith and Lewis 2020, index: 430–431 ‘pneuma, pathology.’ On internal ‘air’ in the Hippocratic corpus referred interchangeably by the terms ἀήρ, ἄνεμος, ἀτμός, πνεῦμα and φύσα, see Craik 2015: 98–99.

21 See Coughlin and Lewis 2020: 218–219.

22 The concept of uterine *empneumatosis* is found already in Hippocrates, cf. *Mul.* 2.70 (p. 400 Potter) ἢν ἄνεμος ἦ ἐν τῇσι μήτρῃσι κτλ.

44 κάρωσεως κρανίου: the word κάρωσις ‘drowsiness, torpor, stupor’ occurs already in Hippocrates (e.g., *Art.* 31). It and its cognates (cf. LSJ s.vv. κάρωσις, κάρως, etc.) imply the head and are often mentioned in connection with it.²³ In the present passage, however, the word κρανίον ‘skull’ is used instead. Since Greek usually distinguishes between the ‘head’ and the ‘skull,’ it could be that κρανίον is used instead of κεφαλή owing to linguistic interference: the words גולגולת in Aramaic and גולגולת in Hebrew mean ‘skull’ as well as ‘head’ (see Sokoloff 2017: 111). Drowsiness or torpor might have been caused by the excess amount of blood, if it is correct to infer from this excessively heavy or frequent menstruation (see our comments in the following line).

45 πολυεμίας: the word refers to an excessive quantity of blood (e.g., in the viscera, cf. Hippocrates, *Flat.* 8). Since the present amulet is for a woman, the term might here refer to an excessive build-up of blood in the womb leading to abnormally heavy or frequent menstruation (Dean-Jones 1989: 177–186). One may also compare the New Testament account of the miraculous cure of the bleeding woman in Mark 5:25–34 and parallels. For charms against this ailment and similar ones, see Baert, Kusters and Sidgwick 2012: 672–678.

46–47 ἀπὸ κακοχυμίας - - ἀπὸ πλήθους χυμο[ῦ]: the two causes of internal disease are an unhealthy state of the humors or a plethora of one humor, cf. e.g., Galen, *De san. tuenda* 7.6 (6.407.12–13 K) ὅσα γὰρ ἐκ τῆς ἐν αὐτῷ κακίας νοσεῖ τὸ σῶμα, διττὴν ἔχει τὴν πρόφασιν, ἥτοι πλήθος ἥτοι κακοχυμίαν. Humoral imbalance and/or abnormal emotions might also have been associated with or, more specifically, regarded as the cause of the aforementioned πολυεμίας and the irregular menstruation this probably implies; see Kazantzidis 2022.

47 πλήθους: or perhaps πληθ<ώρ>ας. χυμο[ῦ: or perhaps χυμῶ<ν>.

48 ἀπὸ ὑστήρας: what one might literally translate as ‘from (the) womb’ here means ‘from an ailment of the womb.’ For the semantic development of ‘part of the body’ to ‘ailment of the part of the body,’ see Strömberg 1937: 188–191, suggesting this, in fact, for the word ὑστέρα in Dioscorides, *Materia Med.* 3.102. For Greek amulets against ailments of the womb, see Faraone 2011: esp. 16–27.

SUMMARY

This silver amulet joins a small group of bilingual Hebrew-Greek amulets from late antiquity. It is unique in its combination of biblical verses and liturgical formulae in Hebrew with specific medical terminology in Greek (some of it probably gynecological). It probably was written in the fourth or fifth century

23 Cf. e.g., Aristotle, *Prob.* 873b13–15.

CE by two scribes, each of whom wrote in his own language and displayed his expertise. Its provenance is unknown, but it resembles another bilingual amulet found near Kibbutz Evron in Western Galilee. It may have been written in the same atelier or by scribes who used similar formularies.

Abbreviations

- AIBMC *Aramaic Incantation Bowls in Museum Collections*, Vol. 1: *The Frau Professor Hilprecht Collection of Babylonian Antiquities Jena* (ed. J.N. Ford and M. Morgenstern), Leiden, 2020
- AMB *Amulets and Magic Bowls: Aramaic Incantations of Late Antiquity* (ed. J. Naveh, S. Shaked), Jerusalem, 1985
- AA *Anecdota Atheniensia I: Textes grecs inédits relatifs à l'histoire des religions* (ed. A. Delatte) Liège, 1927
- BDAG *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament and Other Early Christian Literature* (ed. W. Bauer, F.W. Danker *et al.*), Third edition, Chicago, 2000
- CAMIB *Catalogue of the Aramaic and Mandaic Incantation Bowls in the British Museum* (ed. J.B. Segal), London, 2000
- CIIP *Corpus Inscriptionum Iudaeae/Palestinae* (ed. H.M. Cotton, W. Ameling, W., Eck *et al.*), Berlin, 2010–
- DDD *Dictionary of Deities and Demons in the Bible* (ed. K. van der Toorn, B. Becking and P.W. van der Horst), Leiden, Second edition, 1999
- GMA *Greek Magical Amulets: The Inscribed Gold, Silver, Copper, and Bronze Lamellae. Part I: Published Texts of Known Provenance* (ed. R. Kotansky), Opladen, 1994
- LSJ *A Greek-English Lexicon* (ed. H.G. Liddell, R. Scott and H.S. Jones), Oxford, Ninth edition, 1996
- LGPN *Lexicon of Greek Personal Names* (ed. P.M. Fraser *et al.*), Oxford, 1987–
- MSF *Magic Spells and Formulae: Aramaic Incantations of Late Antiquity* (ed. J. Naveh and S. Shaked) Jerusalem, 1993.
- MTKG *Magische Texte aus der Kairoer Geniza*, 3 vols. (ed. P. Schäfer and S. Shaked), Tübingen, 1994–1999.
- PGM *Papyri Graecae Magicae*, 2 vols. (ed. K. Preisendanz, rev. by A. Heinrichs), Stuttgart, 1973–1974
- SM *Supplementum Magicum*, 2 vols. (ed. R.W. Daniel and F. Maltomini), Opladen, 1990–1992
- ZHSJ *Die Zauberschalentexte in der Hilprecht-Sammlung, Jena, und weitere Nippur-Texte anderer Sammlungen* (ed. C. Müller-Kessler), Wiesbaden, 2005

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